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WSH INSIGHTS

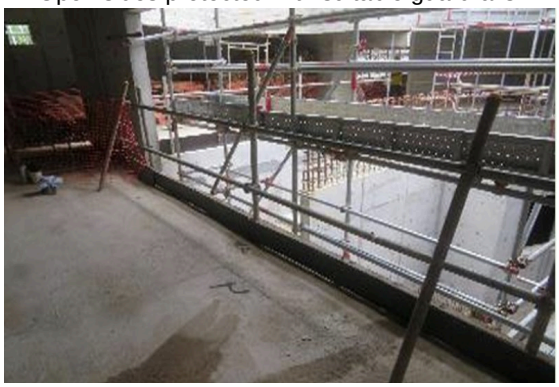
Strengthening Safety in Small-Scale Construction Works

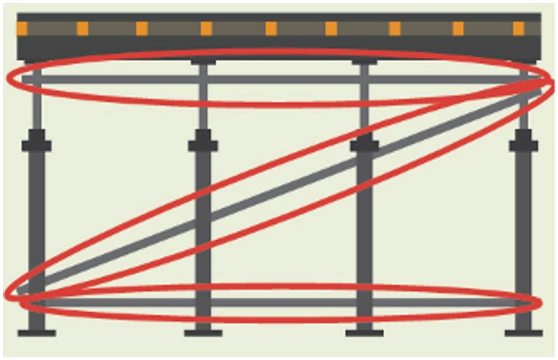
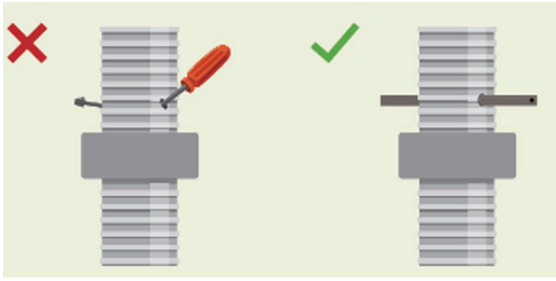
In 2025, small-scale construction works, including addition and alteration (A&A) works and renovation projects, resulted in five fatalities and 90 major injuries[1]. These works accounted for more than 60% of all fatal and major injuries in the construction sector.

Common safety lapses observed include inadequate fall protection, unsafe work at height, improperly assembled formwork, electrical hazards, and unsafe access to and egress from work areas.

In the coming months, the Ministry of Manpower (MOM) will be conducting targeted inspections of small-scale construction works.

The WSH Council strongly encourages companies to conduct thorough risk assessments and strengthen controls for these hazards to be well prepared for MOM's upcoming inspections. The following are examples of good WSH practices commonly adopted by companies to address hazards associated with small-scale construction works.

Good WSH Practices	
Install proper guardrails or barricades at all open sides and floor openings where workers are at risk of falling.	Open sides protected with suitable guardrails.  Floor openings properly covered and barricaded. 

	Clearly mark all open sides and floor openings with prominent safety signages. 
Ensure all formworks are properly erected, braced and supported in accordance with the approved formwork design.	Bracings installed according to design specifications.  Use only approved materials and components. 
Provide and maintain safe access to and egress from all work levels.	Properly constructed staircases for safe movement of workers. 
Deploy only workers who have completed WSH training for work at height (e.g. Workforce Skills Qualifications Perform Work at Height Course).	Workers undergoing training for safe working at height. 

Practise good housekeeping to keep work areas clean, tidy and free of trip hazards.	Materials stored neatly and walkways kept free from obstructions. 
Ensure all electrical installations, equipment and extension cords are properly maintained and protected from damage.	Cable gland protecting the cable from fraying and damage.  All sockets and plugs kept in good condition. 

[1] *Workplace Safety and Health Report 2025, Ministry of Manpower.*

A small job done safely is a big step towards preventing injuries and saving lives.

For more information:

WSH Legislation

WSH Act
WSH (Risk Management) Regulations
WSH (Construction) Regulations 2007
WSH (Scaffolds) Regulations 2011
WSH (Work at Heights) Regulations 2013

Ministry of Manpower

WSH National Statistics Report 2025

Workplace Safety and Health Council

Code of Practice on WSH Risk Management
Code of Practice for Working Safely at Heights
WSH Guidelines on Anchorage, Lifelines and Temporary Edge Protection Systems
WSH Guidelines on Personal Protective Equipment for Work at Heights
Work at Heights Toolkit for Supervisors
Work safely with Formwork
WSH Guidelines on Workplace Housekeeping
WSH Insights: Prevent falls from open sides
WSH Insights: Prevent falls with travel restraints
WSH Insights: Preventing Slips, Trips and Falls
WSH Insights: Strengthening Slip, Trip and Fall Prevention
WSH Insights: Working Safely with Ladders
WSH Insights: Working Safely with Mobile Elevating Work Platforms
WSH Insights: Safeguard Workers from Trips and Falls
WSH Insights: Working Safely on Fragile Surfaces
WSH Insights: Safety in Smaller-scale Construction Works
Ladder Safety Pack
6 Basic WSH Rules for Reducing WSH Risks
6 Basic WSH Rules for Working at Heights
6 Basic WSH Rules for Safe Use of Ladders
6 Basic WSH Rules for Workplace Housekeeping
6 Basic WSH Rules for Use of Electrical Equipment
Activity-Based Checklist for Working Safely at Heights
Activity-Based Checklist for Safe Use of Ladders
Activity-Based Checklist for Slips, Trips and Fall
Activity-Based Checklist for Safe Electrical Maintenance Work
Unsafe and Safe Practices

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Events on Workplace Safety and Health

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Tripartite Alliance for Workplace Safety and Health

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